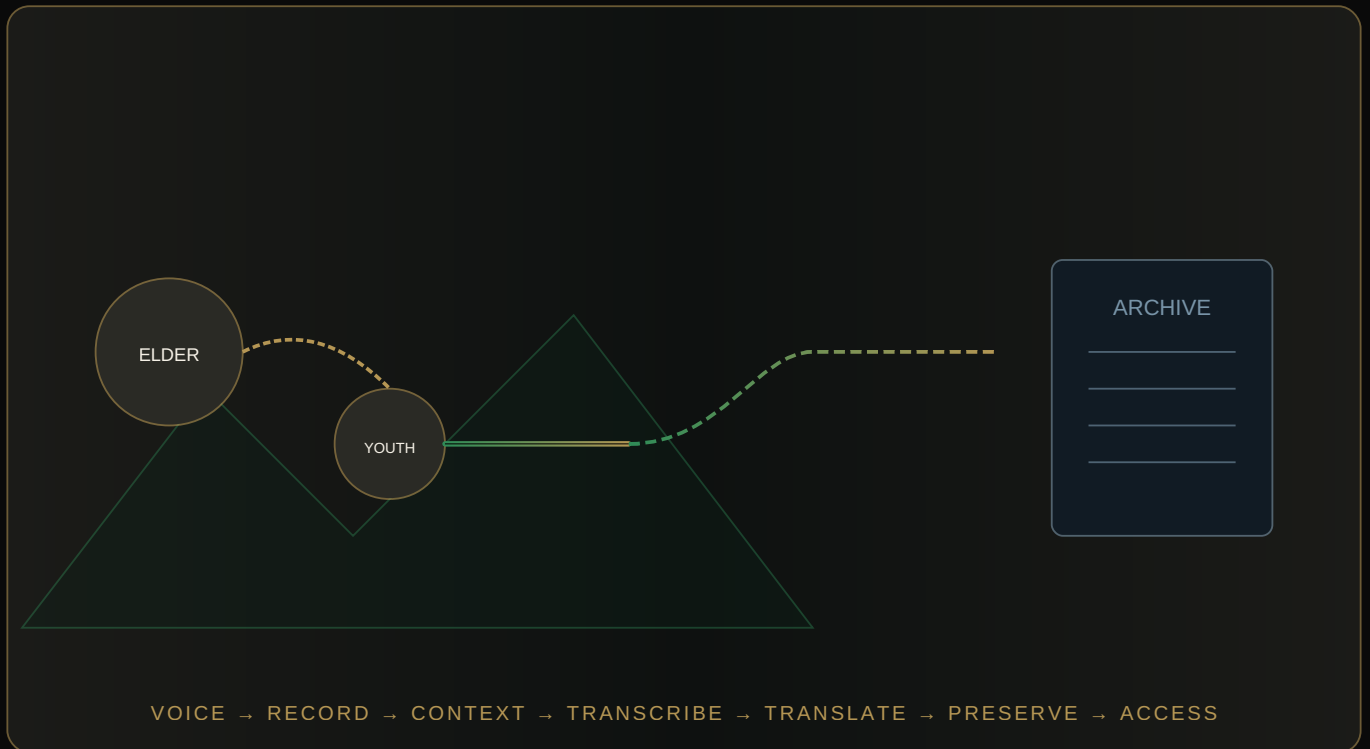


ORAL HISTORY & TECHNOLOGY

“When memory becomes a record, technology can help the next generation listen.”



Oral History & Technology: When memory becomes a record, technology helps the next generation listen.

“Before history becomes a document, it is often a voice. An elder describing a village. A parent remembering migration. A grandmother recalling a family custom. A farmer describing a landscape. A poet reciting lines remembered from another generation. A child asking questions that an older generation may be hearing for the last time.

Oral history captures these voices. Technology gives us new ways to preserve them. A recording can travel across generations. A transcript can make a conversation searchable. A translation can introduce a story to a wider audience. A digital archive can keep a voice available long after the original

recording has become fragile.

But technology must remain a servant of memory. It should preserve the voice without erasing its uncertainty. It should increase access without destroying privacy. And it should help future generations listen without pretending that every memory is an unquestionable fact.”

WHAT IS ORAL HISTORY?

Oral history is a method of documenting people's memories, experiences and interpretations through recorded interviews. It is distinct from folklore or casual conversation because it involves a deliberate methodological approach, documentation, and informed consent. A person's memory may preserve details unavailable elsewhere, but it must be corroborated with other sources as it is evidence of experience rather than automatically verified fact.

Oral History Source: PERSON + MEMORY + INTERVIEW + RECORDING

WHY ORAL HISTORY MATTERS FOR ORAKZAI

For Orakzai communities, oral history can preserve information that may not exist in formal written archives, such as village life, Hujra traditions, traditional sports, and women's household experiences. We do not claim that undocumented traditions exist merely because they could be recorded; rather, we provide the framework for their responsible documentation.

LANGUAGE AND TRANSCRIPTION

Pashto is a vital archival language. Preserving original Pashto recordings alongside transcripts and translations is essential for maintaining cultural nuance, metaphors, and dialect variation. We distinguish between **verbatim** and **edited** transcripts and emphasize that machine translation is an assistant, not a final authority.

ORAL HISTORY CLAIM MATRIX

Claim	Subject	Evidence	Source	Confidence
Voice as Primary Source	Methodology	OHA Manual	OHA (2024)	High
Pashto Oral Vitality	Culture	CAP Documentation	CAP (2023)	High

Claim	Subject	Evidence	Source	Confidence
Digital Resilience (3-2-1)	Technology	DPC/OHA Guidelines	OHA (2024)	High
AI Transcription Risk	Technology	Archival Ethics Research	Lucidea (2025)	High

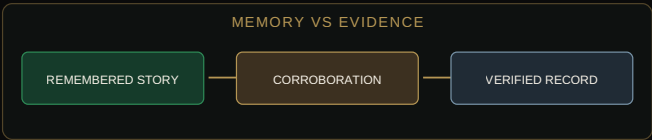
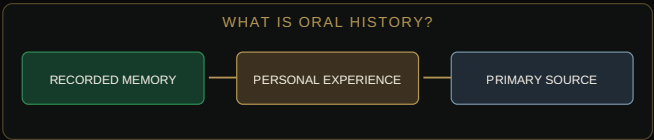
ETHICS AND CONSENT

Consent is not a single sentence; it involves multiple decisions about recording, transcribing, publishing, and sharing. Informed consent is the ethical foundation of oral history. Privacy must be respected, especially for sensitive stories involving trauma, conflict, or living individuals. We distinguish between **Ethical Best Practice** and legal requirements.

AI AND HISTORICAL MEMORY

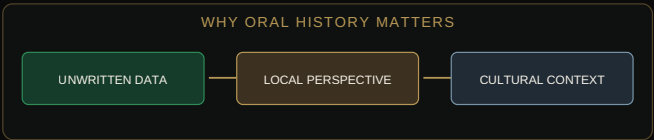
AI can assist with speech-to-text, translation, and summarization, but it should never manufacture missing evidence. We do not automatically assume AI output is correct. AI-generated text is not evidence of historical truth. Human review is the final authority to ensure authenticity and prevent the fabrication of history. We do not claim that technology can independently preserve culture; evidence is limited regarding AI's ability to capture deep cultural context.

LOGIC ATLAS: ORAL HISTORY & TECHNOLOGY



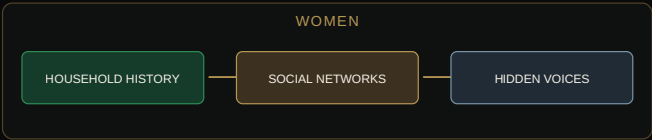
1. What is oral history? — oral history framework.

2. Memory vs evidence — oral history framework.



3. Why oral history matters — oral history framework.

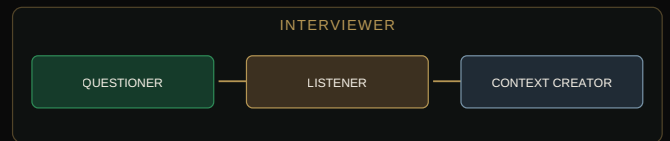
4. Whose voice? — oral history framework.



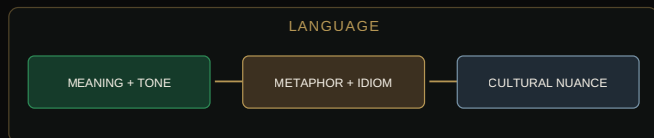
5. Elders — oral history framework.



6. Women — oral history framework.



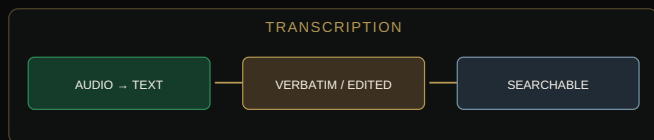
7. Youth — oral history framework.



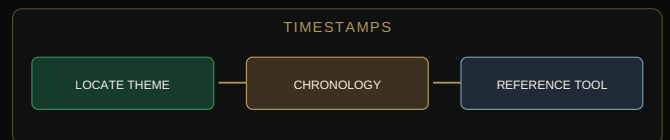
8. Interviewer — oral history framework.



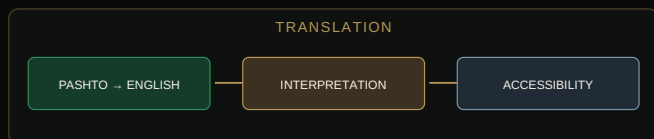
9. Language — oral history framework.



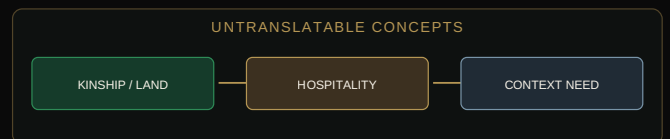
10. Pashto archive — oral history framework.



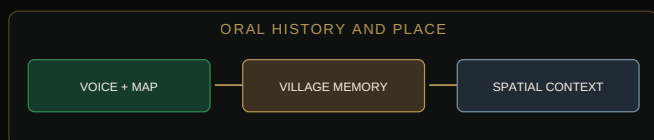
11. Transcription — oral history framework.



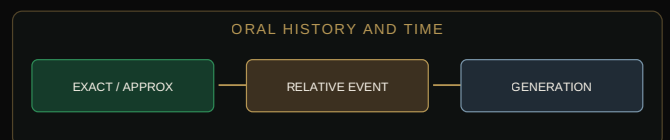
12. Timestamps — oral history framework.



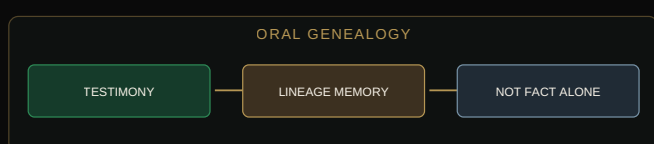
13. Translation — oral history framework.



14. Untranslatable concepts — oral history framework.



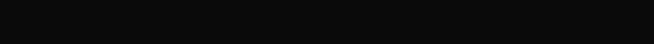
15. Oral history and place — oral history framework.



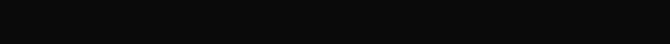
16. Oral history and time — oral history framework.

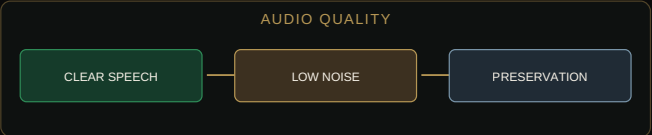


17. Oral genealogy — oral history framework.

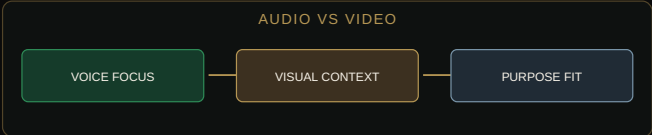


18. Recording technology — oral history framework.

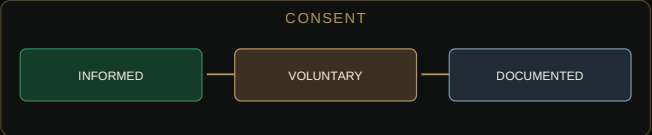




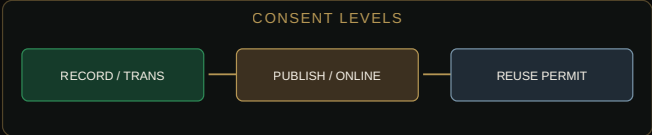
19. Audio quality — oral history framework.



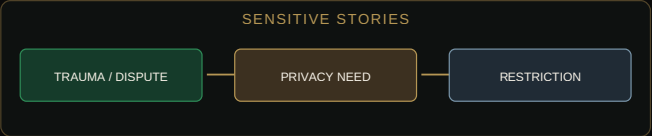
20. Audio vs video — oral history framework.



21. Consent — oral history framework.



22. Consent levels — oral history framework.



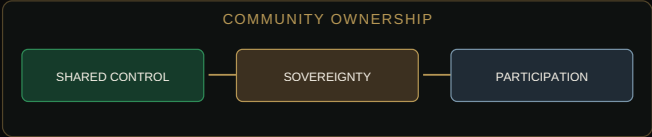
23. Sensitive stories — oral history framework.



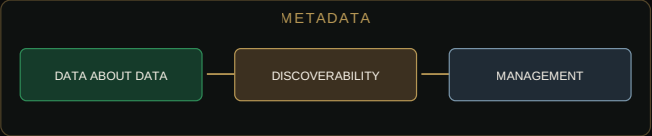
24. Privacy — oral history framework.



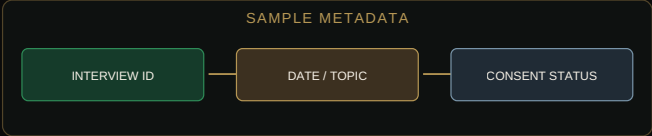
25. Rights — oral history framework.



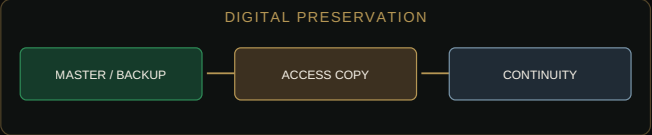
26. Community ownership — oral history framework.



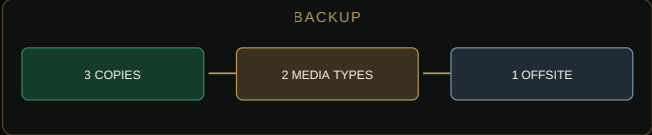
27. Metadata — oral history framework.



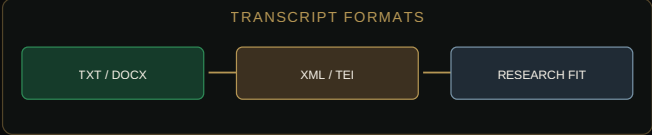
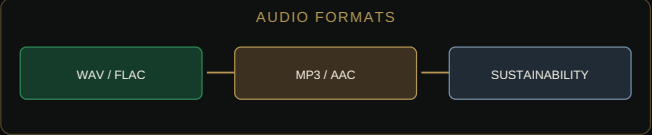
28. Sample metadata — oral history framework.



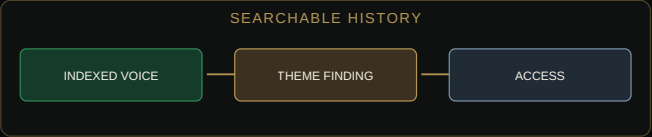
29. Digital preservation — oral history framework.



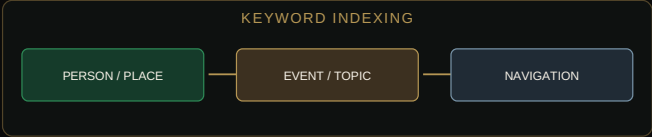
30. Backup — oral history framework.



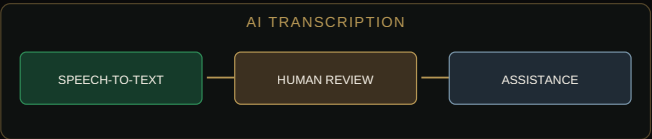
31. Audio formats — oral history framework.



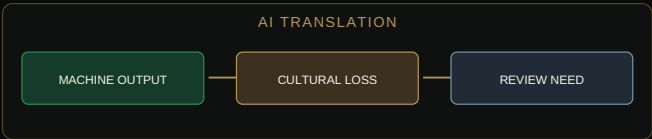
32. Transcript formats — oral history framework.



33. Searchable history — oral history framework.



34. Keyword indexing — oral history framework.



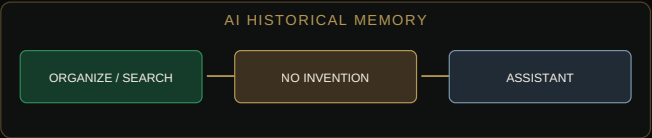
35. AI transcription — oral history framework.



36. AI translation — oral history framework.



37. AI speaker ID — oral history framework.



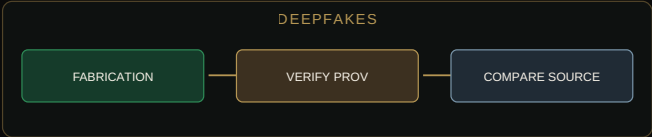
38. AI summarization — oral history framework.



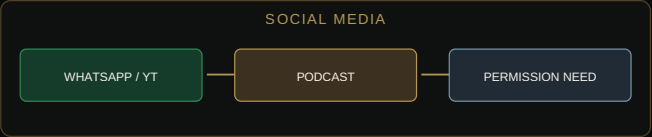
39. AI historical memory — oral history framework.



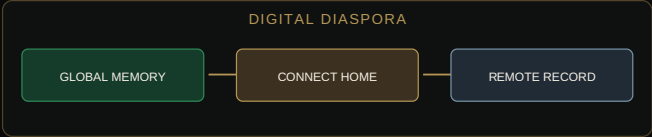
40. Synthetic voices — oral history framework.



41. Digital restoration — oral history framework.

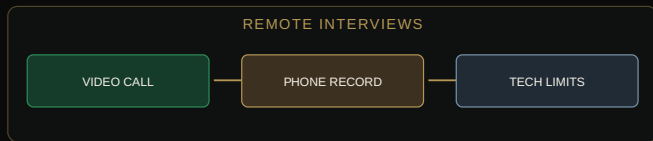


42. Deepfakes — oral history framework.



43. Social media — oral history framework.

44. Digital diaspora — oral history framework.



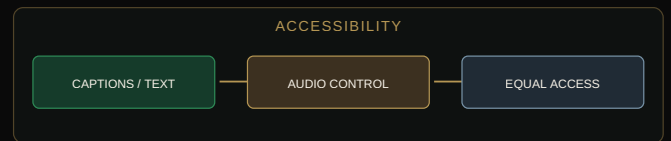
45. Remote interviews — oral history framework.



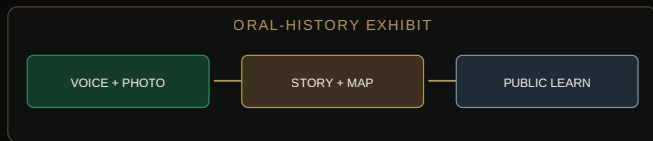
46. Children — oral history framework.



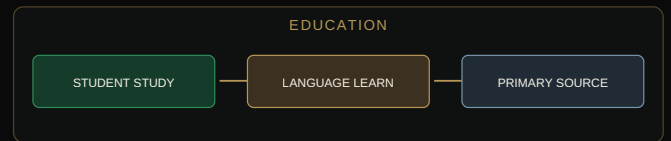
47. Elders and tech — oral history framework.



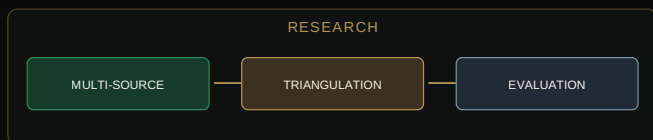
48. Accessibility — oral history framework.



49. Oral-history exhibit — oral history framework.



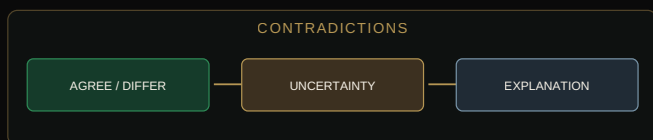
50. Education — oral history framework.



51. Research — oral history framework.



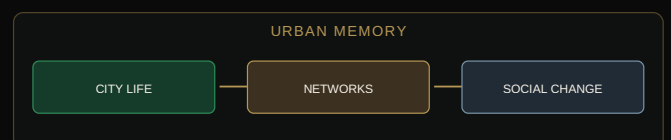
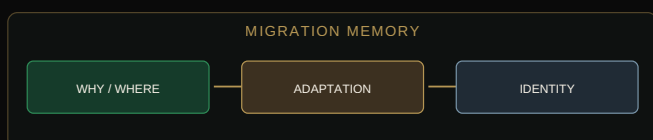
52. Corroboration — oral history framework.



53. Contradictions — oral history framework.

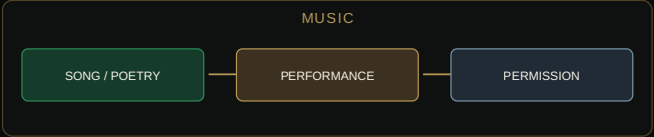


54. Trauma-sensitive — oral history framework.



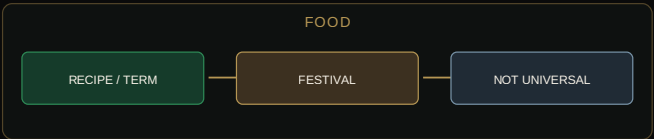
55. Migration memory — oral history framework.

56. Urban memory — oral history framework.



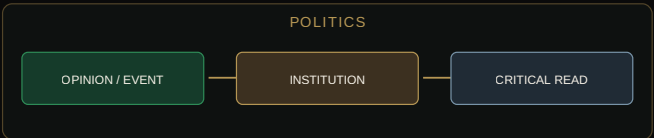
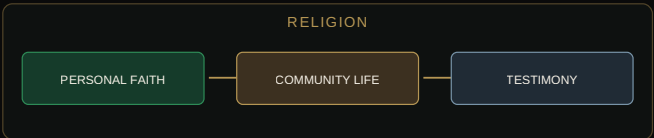
57. Family archive — oral history framework.

58. Music — oral history framework.



59. Proverbs — oral history framework.

60. Food — oral history framework.



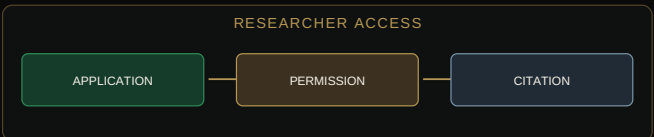
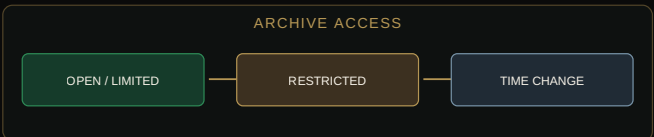
61. Religion — oral history framework.

62. Politics — oral history framework.



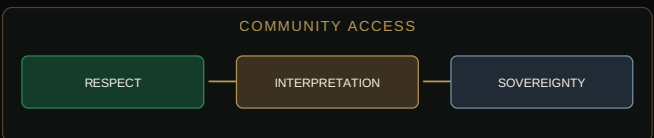
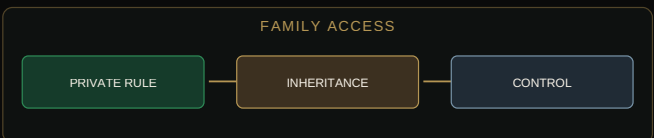
63. Colonial history — oral history framework.

64. Post-1947 history — oral history framework.



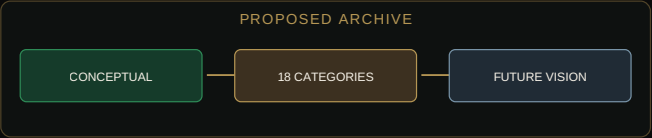
65. Archive access — oral history framework.

66. Researcher access — oral history framework.



67. Family access — oral history framework.

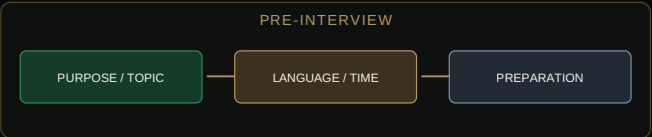
68. Community access — oral history framework.



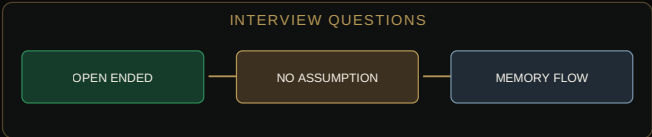
69. Proposed archive — oral history framework.



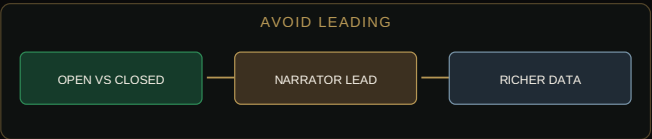
70. Interview workflow — oral history framework.



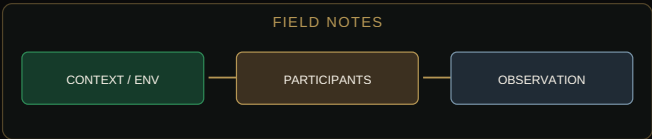
71. Pre-interview — oral history framework.



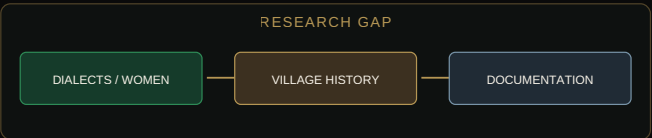
72. Interview questions — oral history framework.



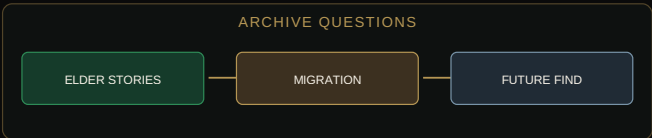
73. Avoid leading — oral history framework.



74. Field notes — oral history framework.



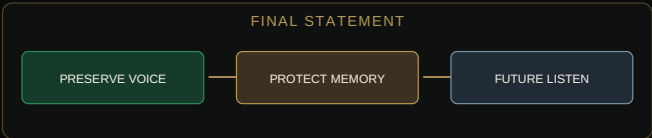
75. Research gap — oral history framework.



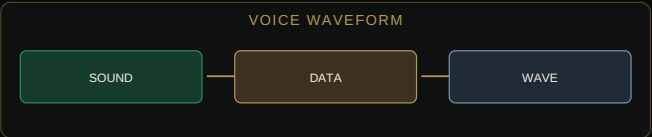
76. Archive questions — oral history framework.



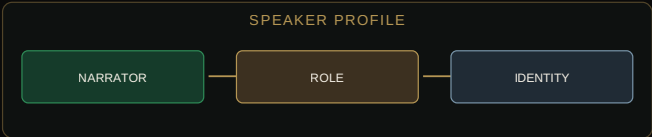
77. Author reflection — oral history framework.



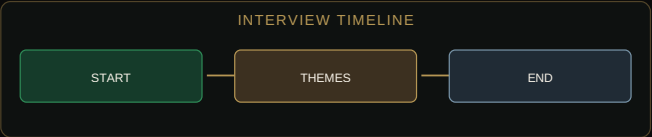
78. Final statement — oral history framework.



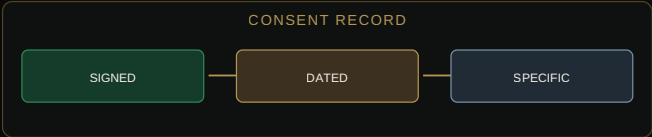
79. Voice waveform — oral history framework.



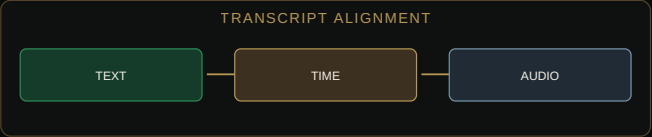
80. Speaker profile — oral history framework.



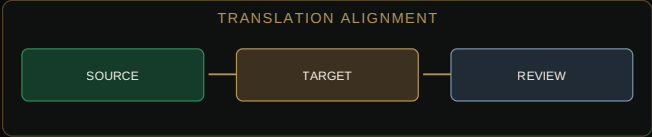
81. Interview timeline — oral history framework.



82. Consent record — oral history framework.



83. Transcript alignment — oral history framework.



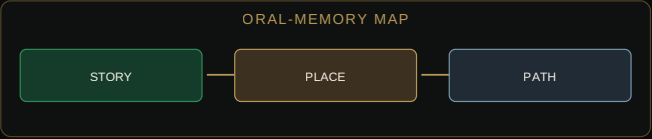
84. Translation alignment — oral history framework.



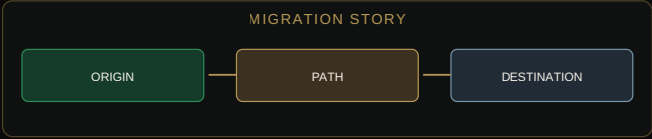
85. Source comparison — oral history framework.



86. Evidence confidence — oral history framework.



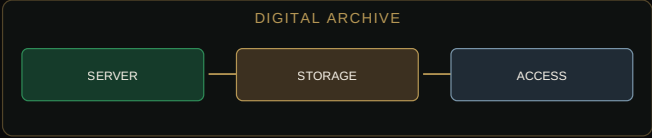
87. Oral-memory map — oral history framework.



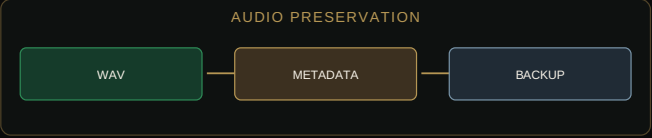
88. Migration story — oral history framework.



89. Family memory tree — oral history framework.



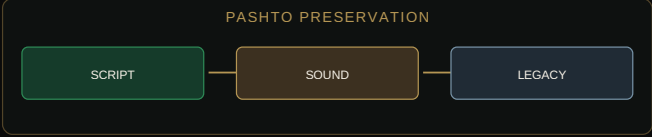
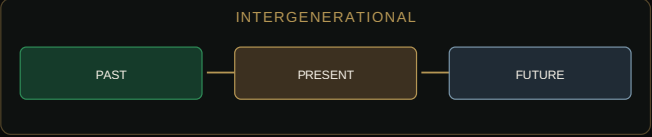
90. Digital archive — oral history framework.



91. Audio preservation — oral history framework.

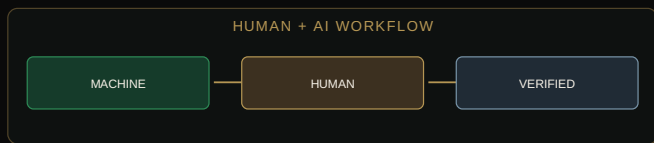


92. Future researcher — oral history framework.



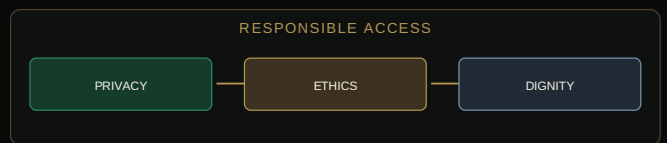
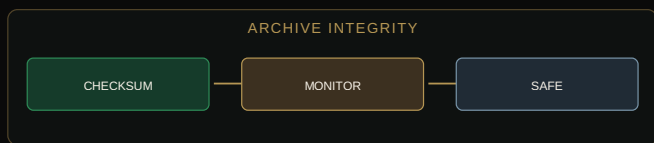
93. Intergenerational — oral history framework.

94. Pashto preservation — oral history framework.



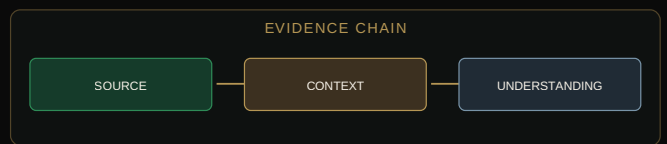
95. Human + AI workflow — oral history framework.

96. Source verification — oral history framework.



97. Archive integrity — oral history framework.

98. Responsible access — oral history framework.



99. Voice-to-archive — oral history framework.

100. Evidence chain — oral history framework.

PROPOSED ORAKZAI ORAL HISTORY ARCHIVE — CONCEPT

- ELDERS
- WOMEN
- YOUTH
- FAMILY STORIES
- VILLAGE MEMORY
- MIGRATION
- DIASPORA
- LANGUAGE
- MUSIC
- POETRY
- PROVERBS
- EDUCATION
- AGRICULTURE
- MARKETS
- RELIGIOUS LIFE
- URBAN MEMORY
- HISTORICAL TESTIMONY

PROPOSED CONCEPT — NOT A CLAIM THAT THIS ARCHIVE CURRENTLY EXISTS.

INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

1. Where did you grow up?
2. What do you remember about your village?

3. What did your family teach you?

4. What was school like?

5. How did people travel?

6. What did the market look like?

7. What role did the Hujra play?

8. What celebrations do you remember?

9. What songs or proverbs do you remember?
10. What changed during your lifetime?

11. Why did people migrate?

12. What do you remember about cities?

13. What traditions have changed?

14. What traditions have disappeared?

15. What should young people remember?

AUTHOR'S REFLECTION

“A voice is fragile. It exists in a moment. Then the conversation ends. The person who remembered it grows older. The language changes. The place changes. And eventually, the voice may disappear. Technology gives us an opportunity to slow that disappearance. A recording can preserve the sound of an elder's voice. A transcript can preserve the words. A translation can open the story to another audience. An archive can preserve the context.

But none of these should replace the person behind the memory. For me, the purpose of oral history is not to turn every memory into a fact. It is to give memory a responsible place in the historical record. The future should be able to hear what earlier generations remembered, while also understanding what remains uncertain. If we listen carefully today, tomorrow's generation will inherit more than photographs and documents. They will inherit voices.”

PRESERVE THE VOICE. PROTECT THE MEMORY.
VERIFY THE RECORD.
LET FUTURE GENERATIONS LISTEN.

RESEARCH SOURCES & FOOTNOTES

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5. Smithsonian Institution Archives, "How to Do Oral History," 2024.

